

State Review Learnings:

University of Arkansas – Monticello

Traditional Route

On-Site Review: November 19–20, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, “Candidate Recruitment and Completion,” is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, “Preparing Candidates Effectively,” criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, “Supporting Workforce Needs,” are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

University of Arkansas - Monticello

Traditional Route

Overall Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
APPROACHING	MEETS	MEETS

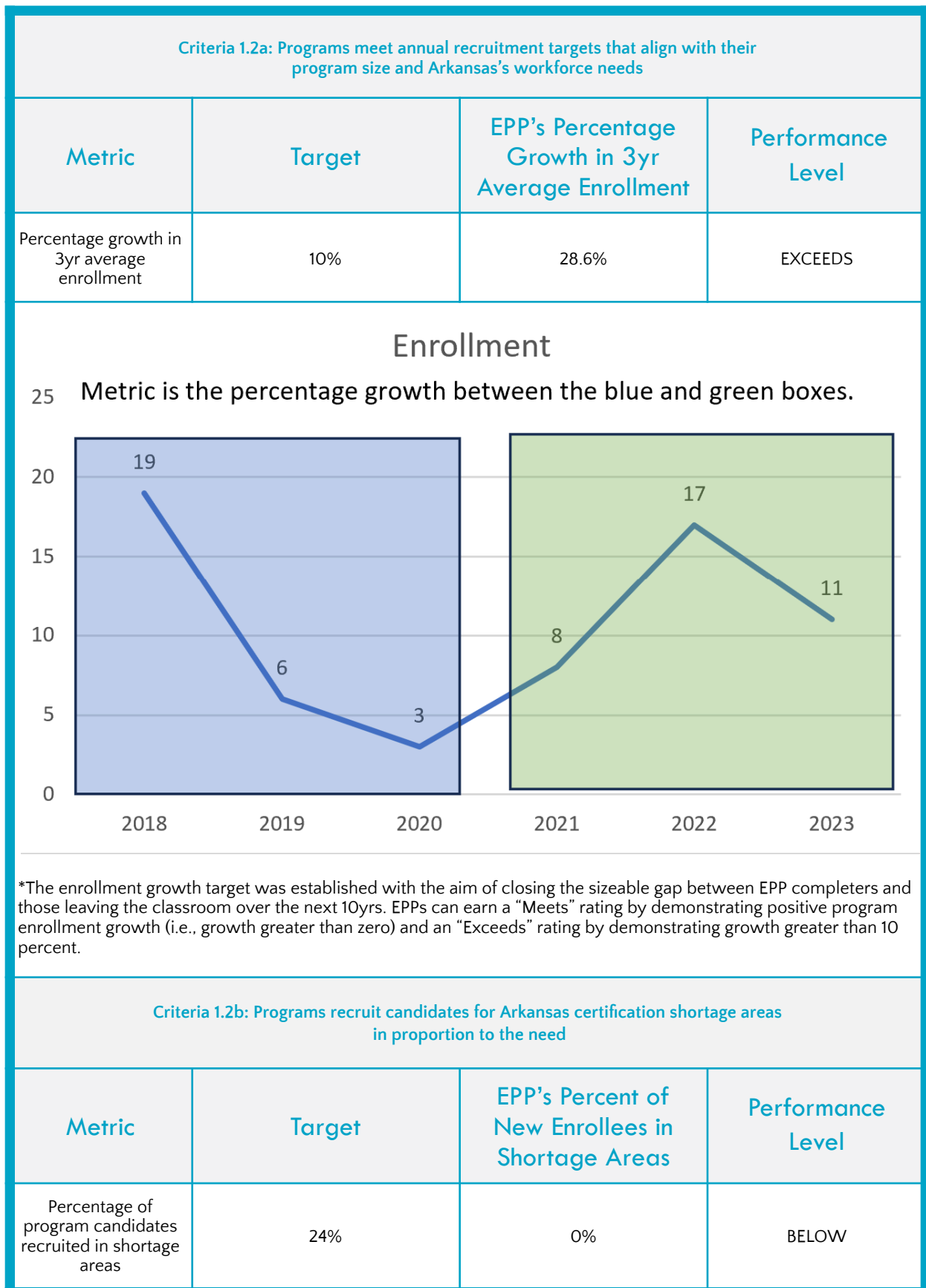
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion

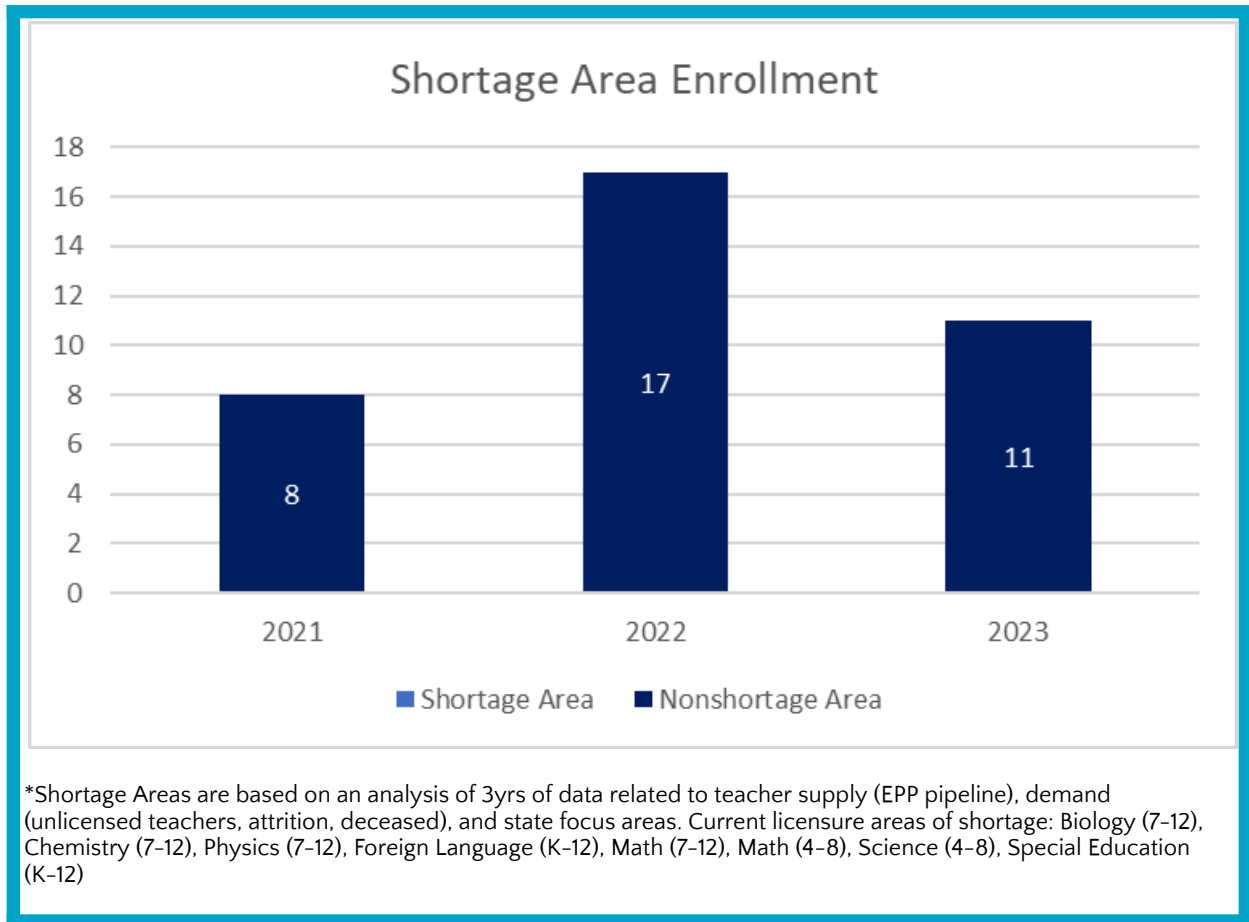
Standard 1 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	BELOW
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: - Recruiting additional candidates to increase overall enrollment, particularly in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a)</i> - Consider what additional supports candidates may need to increase the 3-year completion rate. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.3a)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The UA-Monticello Traditional Programs Annual Plan realistically addresses the program's shortfalls with potential actionable steps for improvement.

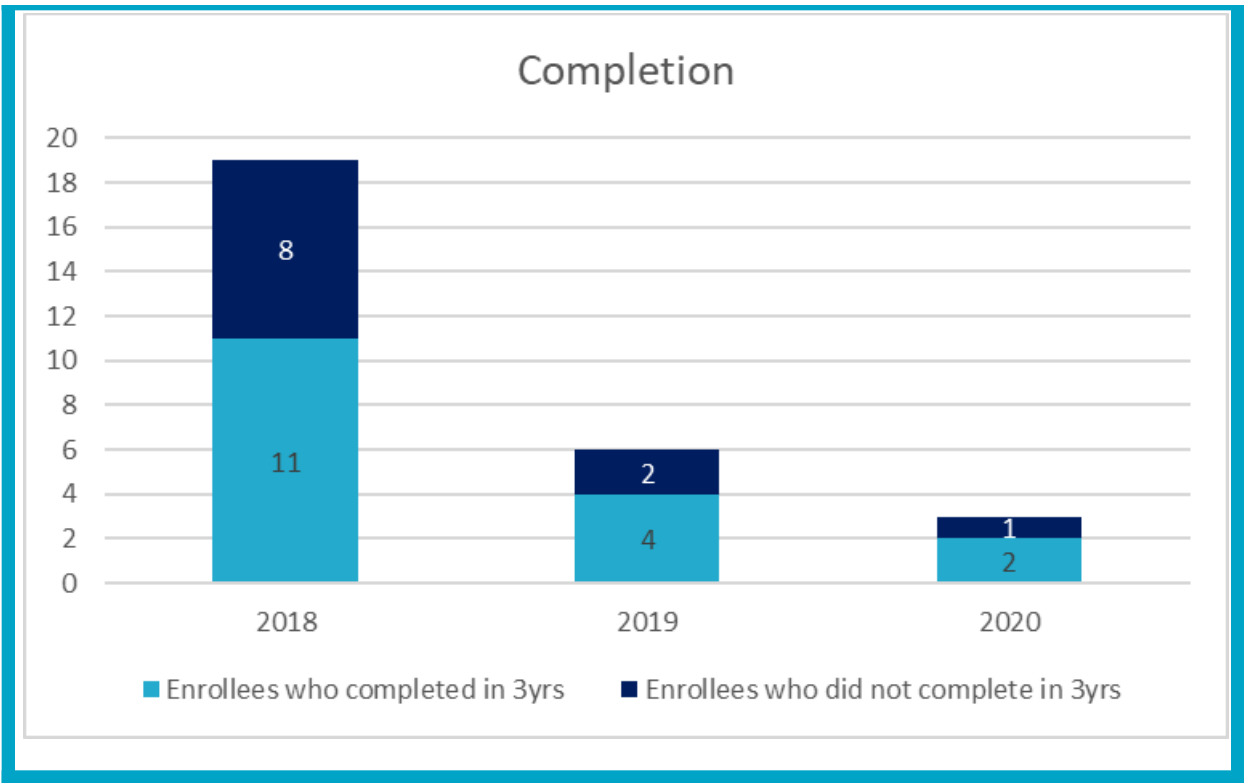
INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT





INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	61%	BELOW



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
The traditional program at UA-Monticello provided evidence of its commitment to preparing teacher candidates to be day-one ready and to provide continual support and feedback. Course instructors and clinical supervisors are a strength at UAM and have strengthened their collaboration with school partners to design clinical experiences. The EPP utilizes best practices, Arkansas Teaching Standards, and HQIM to prepare candidates. Candidates appreciate the “small town” atmosphere they experience. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: • Strengthen collaborative processes and structures to fully support and develop clinical supervisors who provide both faculty and non-faculty various opportunities to participate in training and professional development. (Focus Area: Criteria 2.2c Metric 2) • Create or revise clinical internship goals and milestones and ensure they are communicated to all candidates, course instructors, clinical supervisors, and experienced mentor teachers (Focus Area: Criteria 2.3b, Metric 1)		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS Coursework incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction, including the use of high-quality instructional materials (HQIM) and evidence-based practices. Program documents show intentional integration of best practices across multiple courses, including math methods, literacy, and instructional design. Candidates are introduced to HQIM, such as EnVision, IM, i-Ready, Eureka Math, Phonics First, Foundations, and Benchmark, and several reading courses incorporate the Science of Reading (SOR) competencies and frameworks, such as Scarborough’s Reading Rope. Assignments require candidates to analyze standards, examine vertical alignment, and evaluate or adapt HQIM using tools like EdReports. While some coursework—such as specific secondary science lessons—did not include HQIM, most program materials demonstrate consistent exposure to evidence-based practices across the licensure areas. Focus group participants reinforced that they receive training and practice using HQIM and nationally recognized best practices. Candidates described evaluating multiple curricula, internalizing lessons by annotating them, adapting HQIM for diverse learners, and designing multi-day units aligned to Arkansas standards. They provided specific examples such as reviewing EnVision, IM, and i-Ready in math and applying SOR-aligned strategies in literacy. One candidate explained, “We analyze and look to see if we need to add sources,” showing familiarity with adapting

instructional materials. Participants also noted the use of multisensory strategies, interventions for ELL students, and lesson-planning processes grounded in evidence-based instruction, indicating that coursework prepares them to recognize and use high-quality instructional materials.

Observations further demonstrated the incorporation of best practices. Reviewers saw instructors modeling evidence-based routines, guiding candidates in internalizing HQIM, and prompting reflection on how HQIM aligns with standards and supports student learning. Science instruction incorporated the 5E model and metacognitive reflection, while literacy methods classes modeled multisensory SOR-aligned practices and intentional use of manipulatives. In math lessons, candidates engaged in student-centered tasks that emphasized conceptual understanding and differentiation. Overall, the lessons showed intentional use of evidence-based instructional practices consistent with nationally recognized best practices.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development
MEETS

Coursework clearly familiarizes candidates with the Arkansas K–12 Academic Standards and provides structured opportunities to examine vertical alignment across grade bands. Program documents describe assignments in courses such as Teaching Mathematics (ELED 40203), K–6 Planning, Curriculum, and Programs (ELED 30103), and Teaching Literacy (READ 40133) that require candidates to unpack standards, analyze progression, and evaluate alignment between lesson objectives and Arkansas frameworks. Several courses integrate standards analysis directly into planning tasks. For example, candidates review three grade-level standards before designing aligned lessons or reflect on how adopted HQIM (e.g., EnVision, Foundations, Benchmark) supports Arkansas standards expectations.

In focus groups, candidates gave specific examples of how standards are embedded throughout coursework. Multiple candidates noted that “almost all projects start with the standards,” describing activities such as writing one-sentence learning targets from Arkansas standards, comparing standards across grade levels, and examining vertical alignment in literacy and math. One candidate shared, “We look at the standards to see how they build up and what comes before and after,” while another explained that in their literacy courses, they consistently “unpack the frameworks before planning lessons” and connect them to SOR-aligned instructional strategies. Candidates expressed that standards-based planning was routine and threaded across courses rather than isolated to a single class.

During course observations, reviewers saw explicit and implicit use of Arkansas standards to guide instruction and candidate learning. In coursework centered on HQIM and evidence-based planning, instructors referenced standards when modeling lesson internalization routines and asked candidates to identify where objectives aligned within the standards progression. Candidates discussed standards during collaborative planning activities, and instructors prompted them to justify their instructional decisions based on grade-level expectations. Across observed courses, candidates demonstrated familiarity with identifying standards, connecting them to HQIM lessons, and recognizing how content expectations shift across grade bands, illustrating that coursework consistently and intentionally prepares them to use Arkansas K–12 standards in their future classrooms.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher
MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses
MEETS

Program coursework is intentionally sequenced to build on prior learning, reinforce foundational concepts, and increase in rigor as candidates advance. Documents describe a progression beginning with introductory and foundational courses, followed by methods-focused coursework, and culminating in application-heavy classes taken alongside clinical experiences. Courses such as Effective Instructional Management (EDHP 35633), K–6 Planning, Curriculum, and Programs (ELED 30103), and Advanced Teaching Methods (ELED 41203) show a deliberate movement from basic concepts to increasingly complex instructional decision-making, with candidates required to apply content knowledge in lesson planning, HQIM evaluation, and standards-aligned unit design. Across programs, course numbering, prerequisites, and aligned assignments reflect an intentional structure that prepares candidates for progressively deeper engagement.

In focus groups, candidates consistently described how coursework builds over time and prepares them for later fieldwork. One candidate explained, “You learn the content in one course, then the next class is where you learn how

to apply it,” noting that earlier assignments such as writing objectives from standards, completing SOR-aligned practice activities, or annotating HQIM lessons were revisited and expanded in advanced methods courses. Another candidate who took courses out of sequence acknowledged that “it would have made more sense in the order it was supposed to be” because the courses “build on each other.” These descriptions affirm that candidates perceive a clear, cohesive progression that reinforces and deepens their understanding.

Course instructors described this design as purposeful, explaining that early courses build foundational knowledge and later courses require candidates to demonstrate mastery through more complex tasks. Faculty shared examples of moving from guided practice (e.g., unpacking standards in class, analyzing HQIM lessons together) toward independent work (e.g., designing multi-week units, adapting HQIM for diverse learners, conducting data-informed lesson revisions). They emphasized that course expectations increase as candidates approach internship, noting that advanced methods courses and content-specific blocks require a higher level of instructional readiness.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates the Arkansas Educator Competencies and the Arkansas Teaching Standards (ATS) to develop candidates’ knowledge and skills across their licensure areas. Program documents show explicit alignment in multiple courses, with syllabi and matrices referencing ATS, Science of Reading competencies, and content-specific expectations. Courses such as Introduction to Teaching Reading (READ 20233), Teaching Literacy (READ 40133), Teaching Mathematics (ELED 40203), and Effective Instructional Management (EDHP 35633) embed competencies through assignments that require candidates to plan instruction, analyze student needs, and apply evidence-based practices. Across programs, coursework integrates frameworks such as SOR, HQIM competencies, and discipline-specific pedagogical standards, demonstrating intentional and repeated exposure to what Arkansas expects teachers to know and be able to do.

In focus groups, candidates described multiple opportunities to learn and apply teaching standards, even if they did not always explicitly name ATS. Candidates shared specific examples of learning “what a teacher should know at that grade level,” connecting Arkansas standards and competencies to lesson planning, HQIM evaluation, and literacy instruction. One candidate explained that their literacy professor modeled standards-aligned instruction using SOR routines and then required them to replicate these practices in peer teaching and lesson design. Others described assignments that require reflection on how HQIM aligns with ATS expectations for planning, instruction, and assessment, noting that “we always talk about what the teacher should be doing and why—what the standard is asking for.”

Course instructors confirmed that the program is intentionally designed around educator competencies and ATS. Faculty explained that they “sat around the table with the standards” to determine where competencies are introduced, reinforced, and deepened across the program. Instructors described making competencies visible to candidates through planning templates, literacy modeling, HQIM analysis, and structured reflection tied to domains of effective teaching. Observed classes further demonstrated alignment with ATS, even when standards were not explicitly named, through modeling of evidence-based instructional practices, SOR-aligned routines, lesson internalization using HQIM, and discussions grounded in teacher competencies related to planning, instructional delivery, differentiation, and assessment.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience MEETS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned with candidates’ clinical experiences, providing structured opportunities to apply theoretical learning in real classrooms and reflect on those connections with instructors and supervisors. Program materials, including the “Field Experience Matrix,” “syllabi tracker,” and “field feedback forms,” outline purposeful expectations for observation, application, and reflection that correspond to course content. Assignments require candidates to analyze Arkansas K–12 Standards, identify HQIM components, and connect evidence-based practices from coursework to what they observe in partner classrooms. For example, in literacy coursework aligned to Take Flight Dyslexia and other early reading programs, candidates observe lessons in first-grade classrooms and later analyze how SOR-aligned strategies and Arkansas Teaching Standards were demonstrated during instruction.

In focus groups, several candidates described making clear connections between methods coursework and field observations, noting that instructors “model what to look for in the lesson” before visiting classrooms and then require

written reflections afterward. One candidate shared, “We looked at how the teacher implemented differentiation strategies, and it helped me see how the strategies we learned in class translate directly to real students.” Candidates also referenced structured conversations with mentor teachers and supervisors during POP cycles, explaining that they routinely discuss how strategies from Educational Psychology, Special Education methods, and lesson planning coursework show up in their classrooms. However, multiple candidates, particularly in earlier years (1–3), noted they mostly “observe and reflect after” rather than practicing teaching, suggesting stronger alignment emerges closer to the internship.

Observed coursework further demonstrated alignment to clinical expectations, as instructors consistently asked candidates to apply standards, HQIM analysis, and SOR practices to their field experiences. Instructors prompted candidates to identify the grade-level standards present during their observations, evaluate whether lessons used HQIM such as Wit & Wisdom, 95% Phonics, or Illustrative Math, and connect what they observed to instructional moves modeled in class. Final projects required candidates to synthesize standards, HQIM elements, educator competencies, and teaching standards, using evidence from field visits to reinforce the connection between coursework and clinical practice.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors MEETS

Program evidence demonstrates that most course instructors show deep knowledge of the Arkansas K–12 Standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. Documentation provided in the “Course Instructor/Clinical Supervisor List” shows that instructors hold advanced degrees (M.Ed., Ed.D.), maintain licensure across multiple areas (elementary education, special education, administration), and bring extensive P–12 teaching experience into their coursework. Many instructors also engage in ongoing professional development, including HQIM training, literacy and math methods training, conference participation, and Science of Reading–aligned learning.

Candidate focus groups reinforced this evidence, with all six participants reporting that their instructors are knowledgeable and able to connect coursework to real classroom practice. Candidates consistently highlighted that instructors had “just been in the classroom themselves” and often shared examples from recent teaching experience. One candidate explained that their instructor frequently said, “Last year I had this situation,” which helped them understand how theoretical content translates into practical decision-making. Candidates emphasized that instructors’ recent, relevant teaching experience made the coursework feel credible, current, and aligned with the realities of Arkansas classrooms.

Course observations further demonstrated instructors’ deep knowledge of standards, content, and pedagogy. In *EDHP 11433*, the instructor accurately modeled how to navigate the Arkansas Academic Standards, explained developmental progressions, and connected standards directly to HQIM programs such as Wit & Wisdom, 95% Phonics, and Illustrative Math. In *Scientific Concepts and Methods (EDHP 30233)*, the instructor demonstrated a strong command of the Arkansas science standards and the 5E model, engaging candidates in detailed discussions about alignment and instructional purpose. In *Teaching Math (ELED 40203)*, the instructor used probing questions—such as “Why did you pair addition and multiplication?”—and provided real-time feedback as candidates internalized lessons, illustrating high-quality facilitation.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors MEETS

Most course instructors demonstrate strong facilitation of coursework and provide meaningful, consistent feedback that supports candidate development, meeting expectations for this metric. Evaluation results from teacher candidates highlight the effectiveness of their course instructors, with almost all candidates agreeing, or strongly agreeing, that they “have more knowledge as a result of the course” and their “instructor is willing to help them learn.” The EPP also provided one example of a faculty evaluation, demonstrating that it has an evaluation process in place and provides regular feedback to instructors on their performance. Candidate focus groups affirmed that instructors are strong facilitators, with all 6 participants agreeing that their instructors model effective instructional practices and provide helpful feedback. Candidates described instructors using strategies such as gradual release (“I do, we do, you

do”) and emphasizing productive struggle to deepen understanding. They appreciated that instructors drew from recent classroom experience, sharing lived examples that helped candidates connect coursework to practice. One candidate noted that instructors “were just in that environment,” which made their explanations and modeling feel relevant and credible.

The observed instruction further demonstrated the effectiveness of the course instructors. In EDHP 11433, the instructor provided clear modeling, step-by-step demonstrations of navigating the Arkansas K–12 Standards, and scaffolded practice tied to candidates’ field observations. In EDHP 30233, the instructor facilitated rigorous discussion through targeted questioning, promoting higher-order thinking and providing immediate feedback. In another observation, reviewers noted that the course instructor facilitated the course through critical thinking and questioning strategies. The candidates were thinking and engaging in discussion with the instructor, facilitating the learning. There was ample feedback through the discourse in the room. Across these courses, instructors circulated during small-group work, provided real-time feedback, and guided candidates in connecting their decisions to standards, assessments, and student needs.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences is clearly and intentionally designed to build upon prior learning, providing candidates with structured opportunities for development across the program. The documentation outlines a coherent progression, beginning with early field experiences tied to coursework and culminating in a residency-based internship that uses the co-teaching model to guide a gradual release of responsibility. The “Traditional Residency Handbook” specifies that interns begin with partial responsibilities during the first four weeks and transition to leading all instructional areas by week 21, demonstrating an intentional structure that increases rigor and autonomy over time. Additionally, the “Field Experience Matrix” requires six targeted field experiences—four hours each in different school settings across two grade bands—ensuring candidates encounter varied environments and developmentally appropriate practices before their internship.

Candidates in the clinical experience focus group consistently described this sequence, explaining that early field experiences helped them build foundational skills, such as classroom management and an understanding of diverse learner needs, before entering their internship. They also reported a clear, intentional transfer of responsibility during the internship, noting that experienced mentor teachers first model lessons and then “pass it to the intern” to teach independently. Alternative pathway participants shared a similar pattern, explaining that their mentor teachers and university supervisors “ease off” responsibilities over the semester to increase independent teaching and decision-making. These reflections indicate that candidates experience a coherent and progressive sequence aligned with program expectations.

Clinical supervisors confirmed aspects of this sequence and identified areas for improvement. All supervisors agreed that candidates build on prior experiences; however, they expressed that more intentional control over placements and field assignments would strengthen the developmental progression. Supervisors noted that ensuring candidates consistently observe highly effective teachers and classrooms implementing HQIM would help make the early field hours more purposeful. Even with these suggested improvements, supervisors affirmed that the overall sequence, particularly the internship structure and the gradual release model, supports candidate learning and development.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides candidates with adequate opportunities to work with students who have varied learning needs, meeting expectations for this metric. Documentation shows that candidates complete 24 hours of early fieldwork across six different schools and two grade bands, ensuring broad exposure to

multiple instructional contexts. The program's partnership with 15 districts in the Southeast Arkansas Cooperative region further broadens the range of classrooms candidates have the opportunity to observe and work in.

Candidates in the clinical experience focus group described multiple opportunities to observe and support varied learners, including structured observations in special education settings followed by whole-group reflection. They shared that field experiences occurred across a wide range of schools and that "we were never placed in the same schools," illustrating meaningful variation in placements. Nine of ten candidates reported experience with students with special needs or other learning needs before the internship; only one middle-level intern noted that their first exposure occurred during the internship, which appears to be connected to EDHP 22533, not requiring field hours.

Clinical supervisors agreed that candidates have opportunities to work with students with varied learning needs, but noted that the level of intentionality varies by course and instructor. Supervisors shared examples of coordinating directly with classroom teachers to ensure candidates had exposure to learners who required modifications or differentiated instruction, and post-observation discussions reinforced the strategies used to meet varied needs. However, supervisors also expressed that placement variation can depend on individual instructors rather than a fully systematized approach. Despite these areas for improvement, the combination of documented district partnerships, candidate experiences across multiple settings, and evidence of exposure to varied learning needs demonstrates that the program provides adequate variety in clinical experiences.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers (EMTs) are equipped with the coaching skills necessary to support candidates' pedagogical development. Program documentation outlines clear selection criteria in the district MOU that require EMTs to hold Lead or Master licensure designations, have at least three years of classroom experience, maintain an "effective" summative evaluation, and complete coaching training. EMTs also participate in an "Orientation Webinar" each semester to review expectations and the "Supervised Residency Handbook." Feedback samples on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric show that 13 of 22 components contained specific comments, demonstrating that many EMTs provide targeted, actionable feedback that supports candidate growth.

Candidate focus groups affirmed that EMTs demonstrate strong coaching skills and contribute directly to their development. Candidates consistently described mentors who provide gradual release of responsibility, model effective instructional practices, and conduct timely check-ins throughout the school day. Several candidates shared examples of mentors helping them refine management routines, adjust instruction, or reflect on key decisions. Experienced mentor teachers in their own focus group echoed this, giving concrete examples. One EMT shared they sat in a student's seat during the candidate's lesson to gain a learner's perspective before giving feedback, and another collaborated with a teacher candidate on an Aspiring Teacher Permit (ATP) to improve classroom procedures and instructional strategies.

Clinical observations also illustrated strong mentoring practices. EMTs modeled effective activities such as "Open House Homework: 3rd Day of 3rd Grade" and "StarBooks," demonstrated HQIM expertise by adjusting Zearn lessons with integrity, and provided concrete instructional strategies (e.g., using sheet protectors for carpet time). Candidates referenced EMT-guided routines such as social contracts and "listening bodies" during pre- and post-conferences.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Program documentation shows that a partial process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers (EMTs), with several strong elements aligned to state expectations, but gaps in consistency prevent the program from fully meeting the criteria. The UAM EMT list identifies 26 mentor teachers with 7-33 years of experience, and more than half (54%) hold a Lead designation. All EMTs received annual evaluations of Proficient, all completed Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR) training, and 42% completed recognized coaching training, indicating progress toward full compliance with future state requirements. Formal qualifications are clearly outlined in the "Traditional Residency Handbook" and

require a minimum of three years of successful teaching, a valid teaching license in the content area, and a demonstrated positive impact on student learning. The district MOU reinforces these expectations by specifying criteria such as a Lead or Master designation, at least three years of experience, an Effective summative evaluation, and required coaching training.

In the Partnership focus group, a building-level administrator described a highly selective vetting process for Lead and Master teachers, noting, “We vet them to make sure the personality is encouraging and caring, but also that there is proven student achievement data... We want our new teachers to be like them,” a statement unanimously supported by participants.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors MEETS

Most clinical supervisors demonstrate a proven history of effective instructional practice and coaching with a positive impact on candidates, meeting expectations for this metric. Documentation shows that all 14 supervisors hold graduate or post-graduate degrees, have PreK–12 teaching experience, and bring documented areas of expertise or research to their role. Several have completed recognized coaching training, including the Student-Centered Coaching course through AR IDEAS, strengthening their skills in feedback and adult learning. Supervisor evaluation survey results further affirm their effectiveness, with all responses rating supervisors as “Highly Supportive” or “Supportive.” In addition, professional development records show ongoing training on intern assignments, mentor coordination, ATR data analysis, apprentice updates, and student learning outcomes.

Candidate focus groups reinforced this evidence, with all participants agreeing that their clinical supervisors provided the coaching support needed for growth. Candidates described supervisors who were deeply trusted, intentional in their feedback, and committed to their development. One ATP teacher shared that they knew their supervisor “had their best interests in mind,” and another emphasized how every aspect of supervision felt purposeful in improving their practice. Experienced mentor teachers also noted positive collaboration with clinical supervisors, sharing examples of how they worked together to improve candidates’ experiences. While one EMT reported less frequent interaction, the majority described effective partnerships that reinforced instructional quality and candidate support.

Clinical observations further confirmed supervisors’ strong coaching practices. Supervisors asked probing, instructional questions during pre-conferences, such as extending candidates’ thinking around differentiation for students with IEPs and strategies for building rapport. Observations showed supervisors providing affirming feedback alongside actionable next steps. For example, one supervisor opened a post-conference by acknowledging growth, then offered targeted guidance on issues like managing choral responses, pacing, non-instructional talk, and professional language with students. Other supervisors demonstrated strong content knowledge, such as clarifying the difference between the standard algorithm and the extended form or emphasizing the importance of internalizing HQIM lessons. These examples collectively show that most clinical supervisors consistently demonstrate effective instructional practices and coaching that positively impact candidate development, meeting expectations for this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates MEETS

Candidates consistently receive high-quality feedback from their clinical supervisors and experienced mentor teachers, meeting expectations for this metric. Documentation shows that candidates complete six POP coaching cycles during the internship, each including written and oral feedback aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR) and tied to evidence of student learning. ATR assessments included specific “Glows” and “Grows,” with one supervisor noting, “The teacher has taken everything I have given her to strengthen her lessons,” followed by actionable steps for improving student engagement and explicit instruction. In another example, 100% of ATR components contained specific evidence and corresponding next steps, demonstrating a robust, consistent feedback process.

Candidate focus groups reinforced this pattern of high-quality feedback. Interns and ATPs described receiving regular verbal feedback throughout the school day and written feedback during formal evaluations. One ATP shared that although they and their mentor did not always talk during the school day, the EMT would “reach out after school to check in about the day and provide support when needed,” demonstrating consistent follow-through. Most of the participants described feedback aligned with the ATR or with comparable tools such as the TESS rubric used in their districts. Clinical supervisors similarly described giving feedback tied to prior observations—such as reminding an

intern to incorporate more small-group instruction—and varying the level of support based on whether the candidate was an ATP or intern.

Observations provided additional evidence of high-quality feedback. Clinical supervisors used structured pre-conference protocols, took detailed notes, and asked probing questions such as “How are you determining partners?” and “What are you doing to differentiate for students with IEPs today?” Post-conferences began with affirmations of growth, followed by precise feedback linked to student learning, such as pacing adjustments, strategies for rapport, or limiting choral responses. One teacher candidate photographed written feedback to help “keep it in focus” for future lessons.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024–25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools
MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place with most partner districts and schools, supporting the co-construction of clinical internships and meeting expectations for this metric. Documentation shows that university personnel, EMTs, superintendents, and principals participate in partnership meetings that include discussions of program data, residency points of pride, and upcoming initiatives. These multi-stakeholder conversations help align expectations for clinical experiences and ensure districts remain connected to program goals. Additionally, ongoing communication between university supervisors and EMTs, including early introductions, coordination on candidate progress, and follow-up conversations throughout the residency, supports a shared understanding of candidate needs and strengthens the collaborative structure.

Focus group evidence reinforces that collaboration is present across most partnerships. Two of the three EMTs described strong, ongoing communication and joint problem-solving with clinical supervisors, noting that their established relationships enhanced their ability to support candidates. EMTs emphasized that these interactions helped them align feedback, clarify expectations, and jointly address areas of growth.

Partnership-level focus group participants further illustrated the collaborative culture, noting that communication is frequent and highly responsive, even if not always guided by a formal structure. One administrator explained that in their rural context, “we are all close. It’s a codependency—we need them and they need us,” highlighting a mutually beneficial relationship that supports candidate development. While communication may be informal at times, stakeholders described a functional, interdependent partnership that ensures candidates receive coordinated support during their clinical internships.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors
APPROACHING

Although the EPP provides some structured opportunities to support and develop clinical supervisors, the overall system is not applied consistently across the program. Documentation shows that new university supervisors complete recognized coaching training—such as Student-Centered Coaching— and that agendas and sign-in sheets reflect periodic professional development sessions focused on HQIM, ATR expectations, intern assignments, and program updates.

However, clinical supervisor focus groups indicated that these development processes are inconsistently experienced. Supervisors reported that much of their professional growth is based on personal reflection rather than coordinated training structures. None of the supervisors provided examples of recurring, collaborative training cycles facilitated by the EPP, and the examples shared suggested that development is largely individualized rather than systematically aligned across supervisors.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Documentation shows that most candidates demonstrate proficiency in coursework requirements, with “Stage II—Admitted to Teacher Ed” indicating that 88% (14/16) of candidates met proficiency benchmarks and 100% maintained GPAs above 3.0. The “Middle Level Advisement Report” provides an example of clear, individualized academic guidance that allows candidates to monitor their progress, while the “Clinical Intern Checklist” offers program coordinators a cohort-level snapshot of readiness for internship.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Documentation shows that candidates who are not on track in their coursework are consistently provided with individualized support plans, including examples such as “RM Spring 2026 IP” and the “UAM SOE Academic Support Plan,” which outline specific action steps and progress monitoring. Candidates are informed of these expectations from the outset, as pages 18–20 of the “Handbook for Traditional Residency” clearly describe performance requirements and procedures for initiating support. The program also maintains an “Academic Alerts” system that serves as an early-warning and intervention process, ensuring concerns are identified promptly and candidates receive timely, targeted support.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

APPROACHING

Program documents outline goals and milestones for candidates’ clinical internships. The “Handbook for Traditional Residency” specifies expectations for progression, and the “Clinical Intern Progress Toward Completion” document shows a 91% pass rate, indicating that most candidates complete internship requirements.

In focus groups, candidates and EMTs were able to articulate the program’s clinical expectations, naming requirements such as achieving an overall score of 2 on ATR to progress from Internship I to II and receiving six observations across the two internship semesters. EMTs affirmed that the gradual release of responsibility is clear and that rubrics and paperwork help them understand what candidates are working toward. These descriptions demonstrate that goals and milestones are known to candidates and mentors. However, the review team heard inconsistencies in how clearly these milestones are enacted, particularly for candidates who begin their internship in January. For example, some of these candidates often return from summer break having lost momentum, leading to a “starting over” experience that disrupts the intended developmental progression.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

Program documentation provides adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. Candidates complete three key performance tasks—Planning, Instruction, and Assessment Commentaries—which require them to design standards-aligned lessons, implement instruction, and analyze student evidence to inform next steps. Submitted student-growth artifacts, including a reading growth report and a math growth report, which demonstrate that candidates can measure learning, reflect on results, and adjust instruction accordingly.

Focus groups further confirmed that candidates regularly use student data to support learning. Candidates described specific examples of growth, such as a student who entered below grade level and progressed to writing a whole paragraph, and another example of using student work samples to document learning for RTI groups. Clinical supervisors echoed this, explaining how they review data with interns, ask them to justify RTI group selections, and guide them in providing targeted support. Experienced mentor teachers also reported that interns work with ATLAS

and classroom data, while ATPs routinely review data as part of school-based PLC processes. Clinical observations strengthened this body of evidence. In several observations, candidates clearly analyzed student work, described specific strategies to support next steps (e.g., centers, review routines), and demonstrated responsiveness to student needs. One supervisor noted improved support for handwriting as the candidate monitored and assisted students during independent practice, and also highlighted the candidate's efforts to build metacognitive awareness by asking students why hand motions support letter-sound connections. While one observation showed limited evidence due to time constraints and incomplete exit tickets, the overall observation record confirms that candidates regularly assess student learning, describe its implications, and adjust instruction.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Documentation provides adequate evidence that most candidates demonstrate effective teaching skills by the end of their clinical internship, meeting expectations for this metric. Although cohort sizes in *Pop Cycle Data—Traditional* are small—some as low as one to four candidates—available ATR results show that candidates who were evaluated scored “effective” on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. The *Stage II—Admitted to Teacher Ed* tracker also notes that 14 of 16 eligible candidates (88%) ultimately became licensed, suggesting that the majority met the performance expectations required for program completion. While the tracker includes more than 18 candidates and does not clearly distinguish whether GPAs reflect admission or exit status, the combined evidence indicates that candidates who reach the clinical internship typically achieve the effectiveness benchmarks required for licensure.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

Documentation shows that the program provides support to both struggling and high-performing candidates throughout the clinical internship, meeting expectations for this metric. Candidates who are off track are identified early through the Academic Alerts system, and individualized, time-bound support plans, such as the “Improvement Plan,” outline targeted action steps and monitoring processes. Evidence also shows that high-performing candidates receive recognition and opportunities that encourage retention, including the program’s Intern of the Year award and celebration.

Clinical experience focus groups further affirmed that candidates receive meaningful support during the internship. Candidates shared multiple examples, including supervisors coaching them through challenging moments early in the school year and previous course instructors offering targeted strategies for instructional difficulties. Several noted that “any supervisor” was willing to step in and help, demonstrating a culture of shared support across the faculty. The majority described consistent, accessible coaching and encouragement that helped them grow throughout the internship. Additional confirmation came from clinical supervisors, EMTs, and observation evidence. EMTs reported that struggling interns consistently receive individualized support and cited specific examples of growth resulting from support plans. They also described additional responsibilities and opportunities given to high-performing candidates to promote retention.

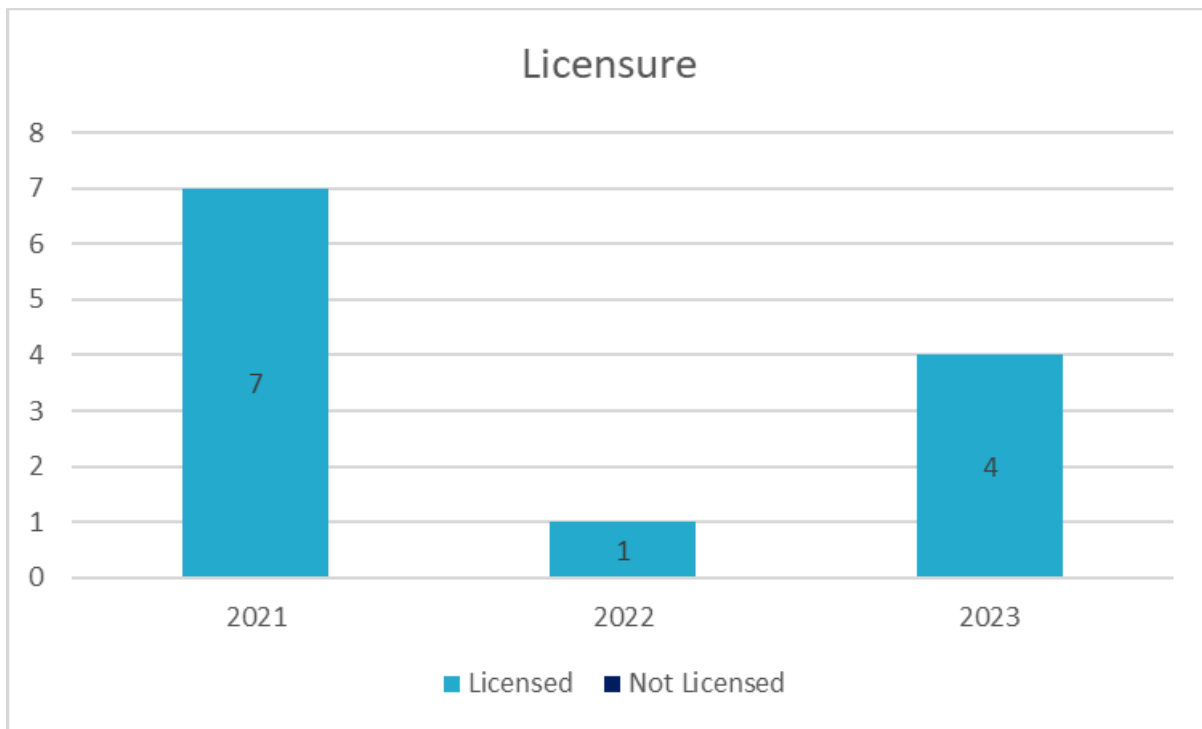
STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level
MEETS
Indicator Performance Levels

Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
MEETS	EXCEEDS	APPROACHING
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that traditional program completers are prepared to pass the content exam on their first try. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.1c)</i> - Continue to review EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify and address specific domains and components for which both supervisors and candidates do not feel their program prepared them well to become a teacher. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3b)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license one year after completion	80%	100%	EXCEEDS

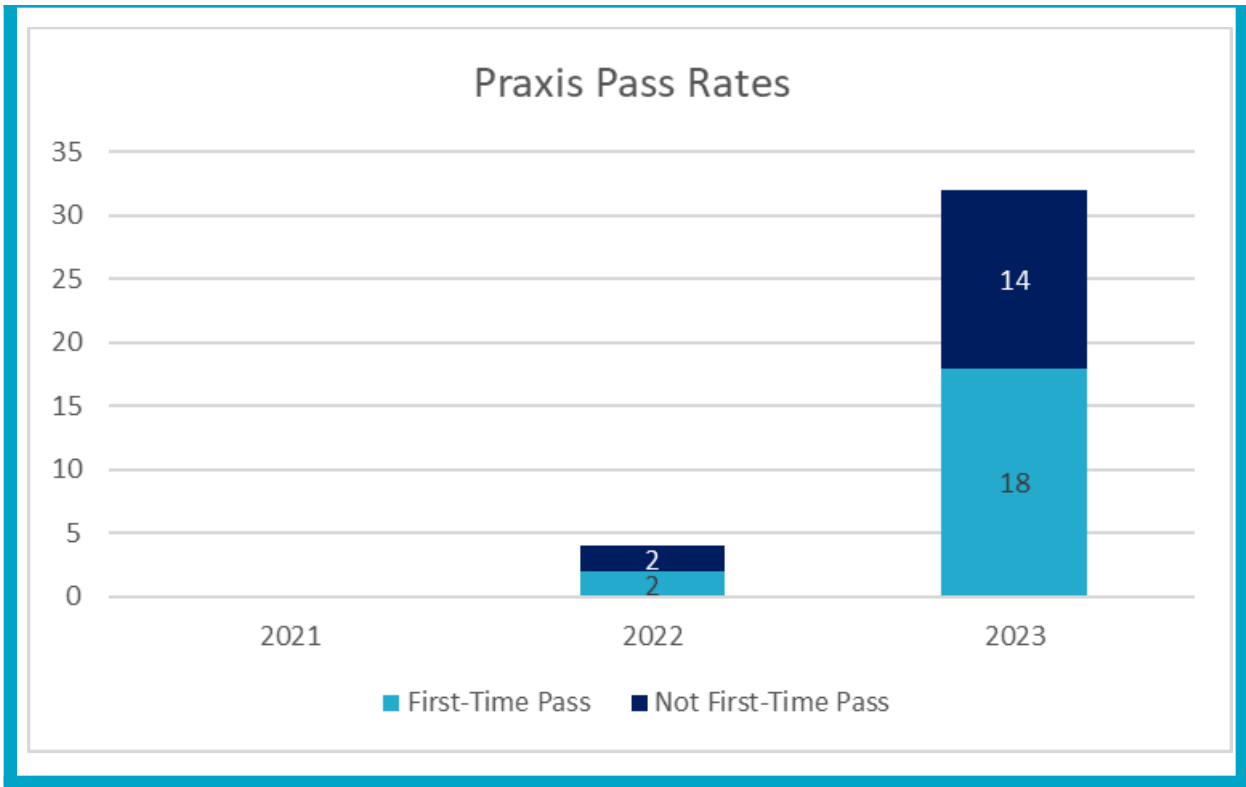


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	n/a	n/a

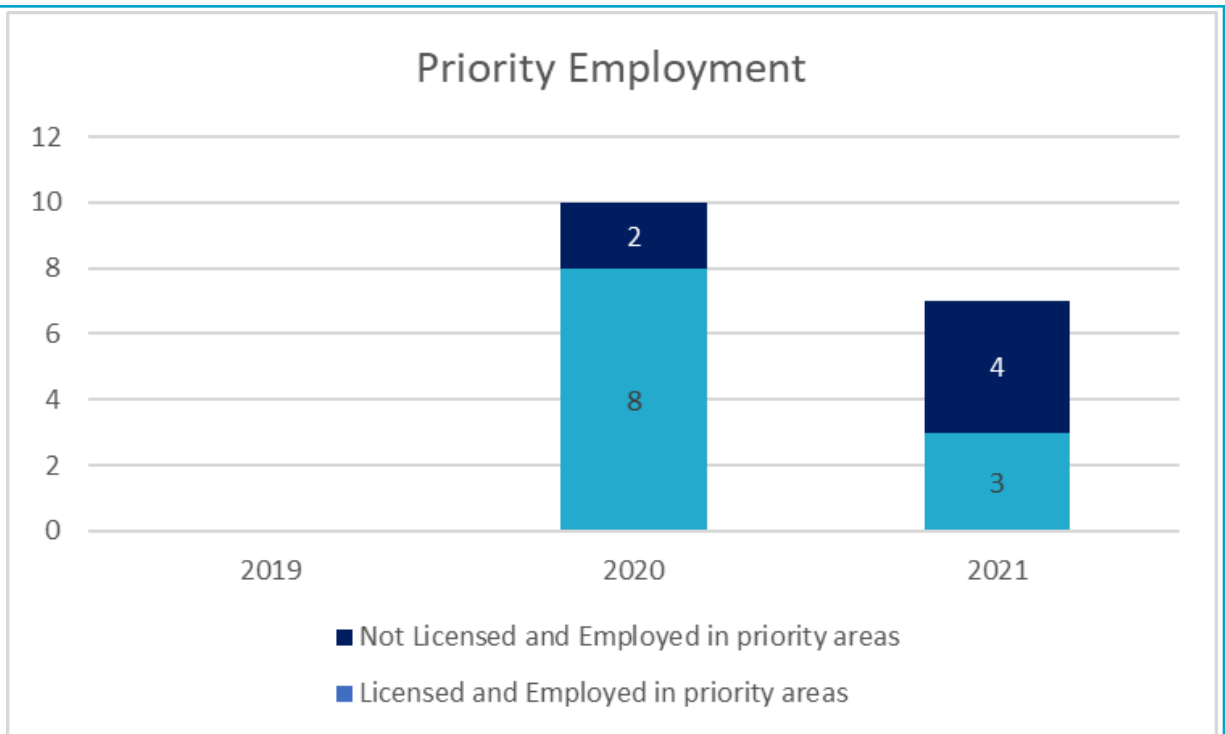
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	56%	APPROACHING



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	77%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and Employed</th><th>Not Licensed and Employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2019</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>9</td><td>1</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>4</td><td>3</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed	2019	0	0	2020	9	1	2021	4	3
Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed													
2019	0	0													
2020	9	1													
2021	4	3													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	65%	EXCEEDS												



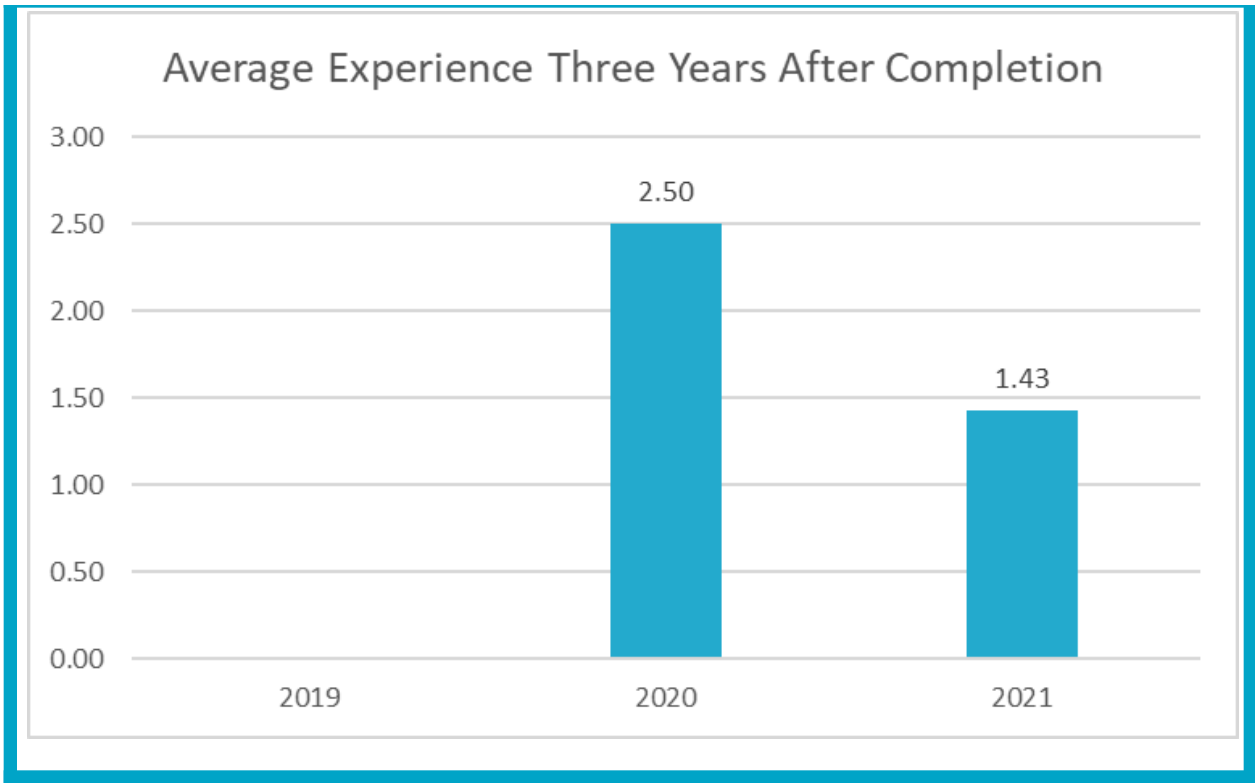
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	2.1	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	75%	MEETS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	50%	BELOW
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	57%	EXCEEDS

